

Website Compliance & Onboarding Checklist

Detailed Explanation of Standard Website Checks for Events Website Onboarding (Payment Gateway / Merchant Compliance Review)

This document explains, in detail, each of the standard checks that a website (such as an events booking platform) must satisfy before it can be approved for payment gateway integration / merchant onboarding in India. These checks are commonly applied by payment aggregators, acquiring banks, and compliance teams to ensure the website is genuine, transparent, legally compliant, and safe for processing customer payments. Each point below includes what is required, why it matters, and practical guidance for an events website.

Section 1: Standard Website Checks

1. URL Must Be Fully Functional

The website's domain (e.g., www.yourevents.com) must load correctly, without broken links, server errors (404/500), expired SSL certificates, or under-construction pages. Every page referenced in the navigation menu — Home, Events, About Us, Contact, Policies, Checkout — must open and render properly on both desktop and mobile.

***Why this matters:** A non-functional or broken website cannot be verified for legitimacy. Payment processors need to see a live, working storefront before they will route real customer transactions through it, since a broken site is a red flag for fraud or an incomplete business.*

2. Content Should Not Fall Under Restricted Categories

The nature of the events/services being sold must not belong to a category restricted or prohibited by the payment aggregator's or card network's policies. Common restricted categories include gambling/betting, adult content, cryptocurrency trading, unregulated investment schemes, tobacco/drugs, weapons, multi-level marketing (MLM)/pyramid schemes, and counterfeit goods.

***Why this matters:** Card networks (Visa/Mastercard/RuPay) and the RBI classify certain business types as high-risk or prohibited. Onboarding such a business exposes the payment aggregator and acquiring bank to regulatory penalties and chargeback risk, so these are screened out early.*

3. The Business Name Must Be Clearly Listed on the Website

The legal/registered business name (the entity that will receive settlements) must appear clearly and consistently — typically in the website footer, About Us page, and Terms & Conditions/Privacy Policy. It should match the name on the business's bank account, GST registration, and the Merchant ID (MID) created with the payment aggregator.

***Why this matters:** This establishes who is legally responsible for the transactions and allows the customer to identify exactly which entity they are paying. A mismatch between the displayed name and the registered entity is one of the most common reasons for compliance rejection.*

4. All Products/Services Must Be Listed

Every event, ticket type, package, or service that will be sold through the payment gateway must be visible and listed on the website with a clear description — for example, concert tickets, workshop passes, conference registrations, or venue bookings.

***Why this matters:** The reviewer must be able to see exactly what the customer is paying for. If the gateway is approved for products that are not listed, it opens the door to undisclosed or unauthorized use of the MID for unrelated/unapproved sales.*

5. Pricing Must Be Displayed in INR/-

All prices for tickets, passes, or services must be shown in Indian Rupees (₹ / INR), inclusive of applicable taxes (GST) where relevant, next to each product or event listing.

***Why this matters:** Since the MID is registered for INR settlement in India, pricing must be transparent and in the local currency so customers are not misled about the amount that will actually be charged to their card or UPI account.*

6. Terms & Conditions, Privacy Policy, and Refund Policy Are Mandatory

The website must have dedicated, accessible pages (usually linked in the footer) for:

- **Terms & Conditions:** governs the rules of using the website and purchasing tickets/services.
- **Privacy Policy:** explains what customer data is collected and how it is used/stored.
- **Refund Policy:** explains under what conditions a customer can get a refund and how.

***Why this matters:** These policies protect both the business and the customer, and are a baseline legal/regulatory requirement for any platform collecting payments and personal data online. Missing policies are an automatic rejection point in most compliance reviews.*

7. Shipping and Return Policies Are Mandatory for All Product-Based Websites

If the events website also sells physical products (e.g., merchandise, event kits, printed tickets/badges shipped to a home address), it must additionally publish a Shipping Policy (how and when goods are dispatched/delivered) and a Return Policy (how physical goods can be returned). For a purely digital ticketing/events business with no physical goods, this may not be applicable — but this should be explicitly confirmed during review.

***Why this matters:** Shipping and returns are unique risks of physical goods (delay, damage, non-delivery) that don't apply to digital tickets, so card networks specifically require these policies whenever tangible products are part of the offering.*

8. Ensure Line of Business (LOB) Clarity

The website's actual business activity (Line of Business) must be clear and must match what was declared during merchant onboarding/KYC with the payment aggregator — e.g., "Event Ticketing & Management Platform." The content, branding, and listed services should not suggest a different or broader business than what was declared (for example, suddenly also selling unrelated retail goods or financial products).

***Why this matters:** Payment aggregators price risk and set transaction limits based on the declared LOB. If the live website doesn't match the declared business, it indicates either misrepresentation at onboarding or unauthorized business expansion — both are compliance violations under RBI's Payment Aggregator guidelines.*

9. Checkout Flow and Add-to-Cart Functionality Must Be Operational

The end-to-end purchase journey — selecting a ticket/package, adding it to a cart, proceeding to checkout, entering customer details, and completing payment — must work without errors. This includes quantity selection, applying discount codes (if any), and reaching the final payment page successfully.

***Why this matters:** Reviewers typically perform a live test transaction. If the checkout flow is broken or incomplete, it suggests the website is not ready for real customer transactions and could lead to failed payments, customer complaints, and chargebacks.*

10. Joint Directors Should Ideally Be Indian Citizens (Good-to-Have Check)

Where the business entity has multiple directors/partners, it is preferable (though not strictly mandatory — marked as "good to have") that joint directors are Indian citizens, particularly relevant for FEMA (Foreign Exchange Management Act) and RBI cross-border compliance considerations.

***Why this matters:** Entities with foreign directors/shareholders can trigger additional regulatory scrutiny (FDI reporting, FEMA compliance) for an India-focused payment business. This check flags such cases for closer review rather than outright rejection.*

11. Shopify Integration: Both URLs Must Redirect to the Same Homepage

If the business uses Shopify as its storefront (e.g., yourstore.myshopify.com) alongside a custom domain (e.g., www.yourevents.com), both URLs must be live, updated with identical content, and configured so that visiting either URL leads the customer to the same homepage experience.

***Why this matters:** This prevents a scenario where one URL shows outdated, incomplete, or different information than the other — which would confuse customers and reviewers about which is the "real" storefront, and could be used to bypass compliance checks on one of the URLs.*

12. Redirection to Different URLs Is Not Allowed on the Same MID

A single Merchant ID (MID) must not be used to accept payments for, or redirect customers to, a completely different/unrelated website or business than the one it was approved for.

***Why this matters:** Each MID is approved against a specific, reviewed business and website. Redirecting it to process payments for an unrelated or unreviewed business is a serious violation that can be used to disguise the true nature of transactions (a practice regulators specifically screen for) and can result in the MID being suspended.*

13. Package Names Must Be Updated for All Android and iOS Applications

If the events business has a mobile app (Android and/or iOS), the app's package name/bundle ID listed on the Google Play Store / Apple App Store must match the registered business name or brand, and must be correctly updated/declared during the compliance review.

***Why this matters:** This confirms the mobile app belongs to the same verified business as the website, and prevents a scenario where payments collected via the app are linked to an unverified or different app/package than what was disclosed.*

Section 2: Important Notes Regarding Policies

A. Correct Entity Name Across All Policies

Every policy page — Terms & Conditions, Privacy Policy, Refund Policy, and (if applicable) Shipping/Return Policy — must mention only the correct, registered legal entity name throughout the document. No other business or entity name (e.g., a parent company, a previous brand name, or an unrelated third party) should appear anywhere in these policies.

Why this matters: If a policy mentions a different entity name than the one being onboarded, it creates legal ambiguity about who the customer's contract is actually with, and who is liable for refunds, data protection, or disputes. This is a very common rejection reason and should be checked carefully by doing a find-and-replace across all policy pages before submission.

B. Shipping and Refund Policies Must State a Clear Timeframe

The Shipping Policy must state a specific, clear timeframe within which the product/ticket/kit will be shipped or delivered (for example, "Physical event kits will be shipped within 5–7 business days of order confirmation"). Similarly, the Refund Policy must state a specific timeframe within which an eligible refund will be processed and credited back to the customer (for example, "Refunds will be processed within 7–10 business days to the original payment method").

Why this matters: Vague language such as "refunds will be processed soon" or "shipping will take some time" is not acceptable, because it gives the customer no enforceable expectation and gives the business no accountable standard. Card networks and aggregators require a defined, specific number of days so that disputes/chargebacks can be assessed against a clear commitment.

Quick Reference Summary

#	Check	Mandatory / Good-to-Have
1	URL fully functional	Mandatory
2	No restricted-category content	Mandatory
3	Business name clearly listed	Mandatory
4	All products/services listed	Mandatory
5	Pricing displayed in INR/-	Mandatory
6	T&C, Privacy, Refund policies present	Mandatory
7	Shipping & Return policies (product sites)	Mandatory if physical goods sold
8	Line of Business (LOB) clarity	Mandatory
9	Checkout / Add-to-cart functional	Mandatory
10	Joint directors Indian citizens	Good to have
11	Shopify + main URL redirect to same homepage	Mandatory (if Shopify used)
12	No redirection to different URL on same MID	Mandatory
13	App package names updated (Android/iOS)	Mandatory (if apps exist)

Action Tip: Before submitting the website for review, do a final pass: (1) confirm the footer shows the correct legal entity name on every page, (2) open Terms, Privacy, Refund, and Shipping policies and search for any incorrect/old entity names, (3) place a real test order through checkout end-to-end, and (4) confirm Shopify and custom domain (if both used) show identical content and redirect to the same homepage.